**Which treatment this guide covers** National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00221a covers adults with locally advanced or metastatic non-small-cell lung cancer (NSCLC) with an activating EGFR mutation who have not received an EGFR TKI. The separate licensed squamous-cancer indication after platinum treatment is not included in this NCCP regimen or its evidence card.

NCCP 00221 · VERSION 5

# Afatinib monotherapy

The usual starting dose is 40 mg by mouth once daily, continuously without a planned rest week. Use the dose on your prescription. Treatment continues while it helps and side effects remain acceptable; any dose change is agreed with your team.

## Make treatment fit into daily life

Take at the same time daily without food: leave at least 3 hours after food before the dose and wait at least 1 hour afterwards before eating. Swallow with water. If missed, take it the same day unless the next dose is due within 8 hours; then skip. Never double a dose or repeat a vomited dose. Ask pharmacy for the approved water-dispersion method if swallowing is difficult.

## Before starting

Confirm the mutation, treatment setting, prescription, baseline tests, first review and emergency contact.

## Taking the tablets

Take at the same time daily without food: leave at least 3 hours after food before the dose and wait at least 1 hour afterwards before eating. Swallow with water. If missed, take it the same day unless the next dose is due within 8 hours; then skip. Never double a dose or repeat a vomited dose. Ask pharmacy for the approved water-dispersion method if swallowing is difficult.

## Supplies and visits

Arrange the next prescription before tablets run out. Keep your blood-test and clinic appointments. The oral regimen itself does not require an infusion line or pump.

## If treatment is held

Ask why, what must recover and when review is due. Only the team authorises restarting or changing dose.

## At treatment change

Agree ongoing symptom care, scans, contraception and follow-up.

## Who arranges each check?

Agree the due window, booking team, result reviewer and whom to contact if an appointment or result is missing. This reference page does not book or record a test.

## Sources and review

The NCCP regimen supplies the treatment rules. Separate guidelines supply the longer-term monitoring recommendations, with their qualifications retained.


- NCCP 00221 v5 · official regimen
- EMA Giotrif product information (updated 11 May 2026)
- NCCP systemic anticancer therapy (SACT) antiemetic guidance V6 (2025), oral tables
- NCCP NCIS antiemetic medicines V8 (2025); parenteral scope
- LUX-Lung 3 primary PFS: Sequist et al., JCO 2013
- LUX-Lung 3/6 mature OS: Yang et al., Lancet Oncology 2015
- LUX-Lung 7 mature OS: Paz-Ares et al., Annals of Oncology 2017


Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending